

SPIDER-WOMAN

Investigator with irresistible powers

The daughter of scientist Jonathan DREW, Jessica gained her powers before birth, when a laser laced with spider DNA hit her mother's womb. Born and raised on Wundagore Mountain, her powers

manifested when she was six years old. She was in stasis for a long time and when she woke found herself in the care of HYDRA.

It was originally believed that Jessica's powers stemmed from an experiment conducted by her father.

SUPER SPY

Trained by the TASKMASTER—and her mind warped by MENTALLO—Jessica became an agent of HYDRA. Captured by SHIELD on her first mission and then released, she went underground. She resurfaced to become an agent of SHIELD for a short time, after which she struck out on her own. Calling herself Spider-Woman, Jessica became a private investigator, a bounty hunter, and a sometime Super Hero. At one point, she saved the life of GIANT-MAN (Bill Foster) through a blood transfusion, and lost some of her powers in the process.

Others took on the name of Spider-Woman but when HYDRA offered to restore Jessica's powers if she would become their agent, she accepted the deal, then contacted Nick FURY and became a double agent for SHIELD. Shortly thereafter, she was kidnapped by the SKRULLS and replaced by Queen Veranke.

While posing as Jessica, Veranke led the Secret Invasion (see pp. 326-7). Norman Osborn shot and killed Veranke in the final battle of the Skrull invasion. Jessica, along with several other replaced heroes, was found in a Skrull prison ship and brought back to Earth. She has since joined the Avengers team led by CAPTAIN AMERICA (Bucky Barnes).



Wings let Spider-Woman glide, and she can now fly unassisted.

KEY STORYLINES

- **The Spider-Woman #1**
The first issue of her original, self-titled series sees Jessica Drew striking out on her own as a hero.
- **Spider-Woman: Origin #1-6**
This limited series retells Spider-Woman's beginnings, from a HYDRA pawn to a member of the New Avengers.
- **New Avengers #1** Jessica Drew returns as Spider-Woman in the New Avengers... or does she?

THE OTHERS

As well as Jessica and Veranke, Julia Carpenter (see ARACHNE) was made Spider-Woman by the COMMISSION ON SUPERHUMAN ACTIVITIES. Mattie Franklin became the third Spider-Woman after taking her father's place during a ceremony called the Gathering of the Five. Later, DOCTOR OCTOPUS gave Charlotte Witter the ability to absorb spider-powers only to have Mattie reclaim them. **DW, MF**

Charlotte Witter was the only villainous Spider-Woman. Doctor Octopus bestowed her with powers sufficient to kill Spider-Man. Witter also possessed the ability to drain the powers of the other Spider-Women, but lost them when defeated by Mattie Franklin.

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Jessica Drew

OCCUPATION

Adventurer

BASE

Mobile

HEIGHT 5 ft 10 in

WEIGHT 130 lbs

EYES Green

HAIR Brown (dyed black)

FIRST APPEARANCE

Marvel Spotlight Vol. 1 #32
(February 1977)

Enhanced strength, speed, and hearing; flight; superhuman healing factor; emits mood-altering pheromones that attract both sexes; ability to adhere to walls and fire electric "venom blasts."

SPIDER-WOMAN

POWERS

